



Manajemen Proyek Sistem Informasi

PROJECT COMMUNICATION MANAGEMENT

S1 SISTEM INFORMASI

FAKULTAS REKAYASA INDUSTRI

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Learning Objectives

- Understand the importance of **good communications on projects** and the **need to develop soft skills**, especially for IT project managers and their teams
- Review key concepts related to communications
- Explain the **elements of planning project communications** and **how to create a communications management plan**
- Describe **how to manage communications**, including communication technologies, media, and performance reporting



Learning Objectives (Cont)

- Discuss **methods for controlling communications** to ensure that **information needs** are met throughout the life of the project
- List various **methods for improving project communications**, such as running effective meetings, using various technologies effectively, and using templates
- Describe **how software can enhance project communications management**



Importance of Good Communications

- The **greatest threat** to many projects is a **failure to communicate**
- Our culture does not portray IT professionals as being good communicators
- Research shows that IT professionals must be able to communicate effectively to succeed in their positions
- Strong verbal skills are a key factor in career advancement for IT professionals



Project Communications Management Processes

- **Planning Communication Management** : involves determining the information and communications needs of the stakeholders.
- **Managing communications** involves creating, distributing, storing, retrieving, and disposing of project communications based on the communications management plan.
- **Controlling communications** involves monitoring and controlling project communications to ensure that stakeholder communication needs are met.



Project Communications Management Summary

Planning

Process: **Plan communications management**

Outputs: Communications management plan, project documents updates

Executing

Process: **Manage communications**

Outputs: Project communications, project documents updates, project management plan updates, and organizational process assets updates

Monitoring and Controlling

Process: **Control communications**

Outputs: Work performance information, change requests, project documents updates, and organizational process assets updates

Project Start

Project Finish



Keys to Good Communication

- Project managers say they spend as much as **90 percent of their time communicating**
- Need to **focus on group and individual communication needs**
- Use **formal and informal methods for communicating**
- Distribute **important information in an effective and timely manner**
- Set the **stage for communicating bad news**
- Determine the **number of communication channels**



Understanding Group and Individual Communication Needs

- People are not interchangeable parts
- As illustrated in Brooks' book *The Mythical Man-Month*, you cannot assume that a task originally scheduled to take two months of one person's time can be done in one month by two people
- Nine women cannot produce a baby in one month!



Importance of Face-to-Face Communication

- Research says that in a face-to-face interaction:
 - 58 percent of communication is through body language.
 - 35 percent of communication is through how the words are said
 - 7 percent of communication is through the content or words that are spoken
- Pay attention to more than just the actual words someone is saying
- A person's tone of voice and body language say a lot about how he or she really feels





Personal Preferences Affect Communication Needs

- Introverts like more private communications, while extroverts like to discuss things in public
- Intuitive people like to understand the big picture, while sensing people need step-by-step details
- Thinkers want to know the logic behind decisions, while feeling people want to know how something affects them personally
- Judging people are driven to meet deadlines while perceiving people need more help in developing and following plans



Encouraging More Face-to-Face Interactions

- Short, frequent meetings are often very effective in IT projects
- Stand-up meetings force people to focus on what they really need to communicate
- Some companies have policies preventing the use of e-mail between certain hours or even entire days of the week



Distributing Information in an Effective and Timely Manner

- Don't bury crucial information
- Don't be afraid to report bad information
- Oral communication via meetings and informal talks helps bring important information—good and bad—out into the open



Other Communication Considerations

- Rarely does the receiver interpret a message exactly as the sender intended
- Geographic location and cultural background affect the complexity of project communications
 - Different working hours
 - Language barriers
 - Different cultural norms



Communication Dimensions

The communication activities involved in these processes may often have many potential dimensions that need to be considered, including, but not limited to:

- ✓ **Internal** (within the project) and **external** (customer, vendors, other projects, organizations, the public);
- ✓ **Formal** (reports, minutes, briefings) and **informal** (emails, memos, ad-hoc discussions);
- ✓ **Vertical** (up and down the organization) and **horizontal** (with peers);
- ✓ **Official** (newsletters, annual report) and **unofficial** (off the record communications); and
- ✓ **Written** and **oral**, and **verbal** (voice inflections) and **nonverbal** (body language).



Communication Dimensions (Cont)

	Formal	Informal
Verbal	Formal Verbal	Informal Verbal
Written	Written Formal	Written Informal

- Written & oral, listening & speaking
- Internal (within the project) & External (customer, media & public)
- Formal (reports, briefings) & Informal (memos, ad hoc conversation)
- Vertical (up & down the organization) & Horizontal (with peers)



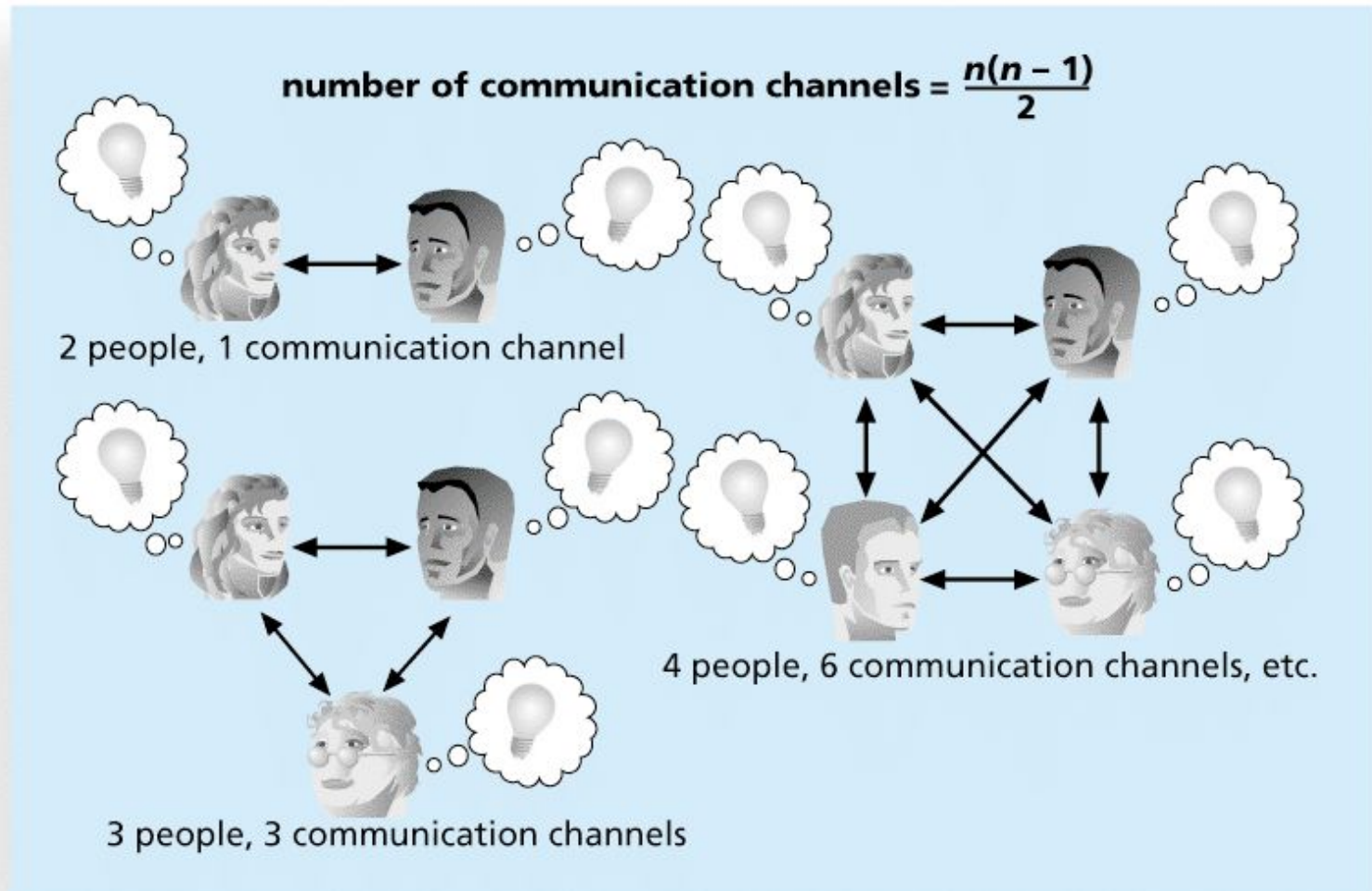


Determining the Number of Communications Channels

- As the number of people involved increases, the complexity of communications increases because there are more communications channels or pathways through which people can communicate.
- Number of communications channels = $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$

where n is the number of people involved

The Impact of the Number of People on Communications Channels





Planning Communications Management

- Every project should include some type of **communications management plan**, a document that guides project communications
- The communications management plan **varies with the needs of the project**, but some type of written plan should always be prepared
- For small projects, **the communications management plan can be part of the team contract**
- For large projects, it should be a separate document



Communications Management Plan Contents

1. Stakeholder communications requirements
2. Information to be communicated, including format, content, and level of detail
3. Who will receive the information and who will produce it
4. Suggested methods or technologies for conveying the information
5. Frequency of communication
6. Escalation procedures for resolving issues
7. Revision procedures for updating the communications management plan
8. A glossary of common terminology



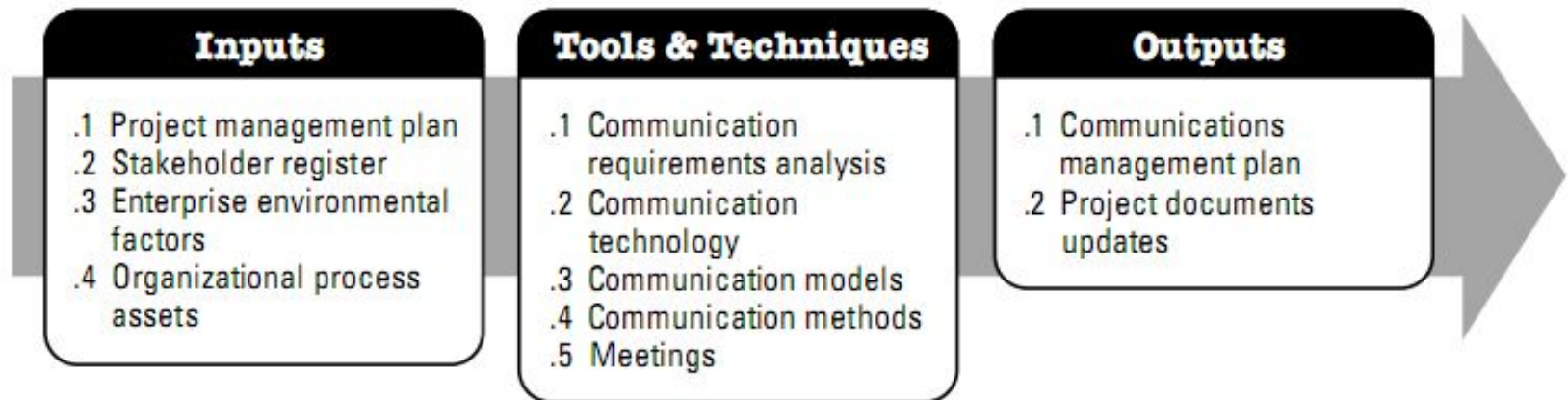
Sample Stakeholder Analysis for Project Communications

Stakeholders	Document Name	Document Format	Contact Person	Due
Customer management	Monthly status report	Hard copy and meeting	Tina Erndt, Tom Silva	First of month
Customer business staff	Monthly status report	Hard copy	Julie Grant, Sergey Cristobal	First of month
Customer technical staff	Monthly status report	E-mail	Li Chau, Nancy Michaels	First of month
Internal management	Monthly status report	Hard copy and meeting	Bob Thomson	First of month
Internal business and technical staff	Monthly status report	Intranet	Angie Liu	First of month
Training subcontractor	Training plan	Hard copy	Jonathan Kraus	November 1
Software subcontractor	Software implementation plan	E-mail	Najwa Gates	June 1

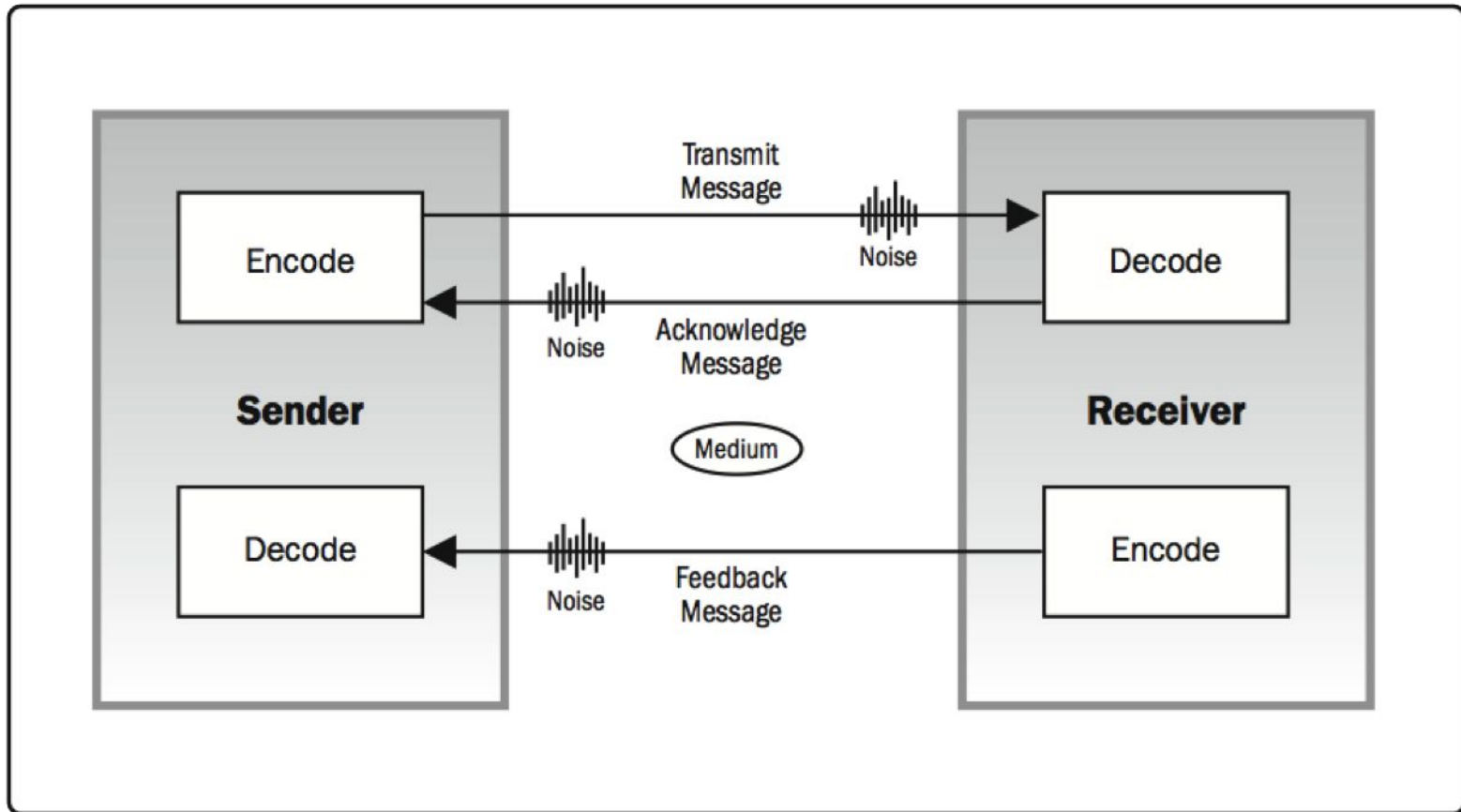
Comments: Put the titles and dates of documents in e-mail headings and have recipients acknowledge receipt.

Plan Communication Management

ITTO



Basic Communication Model





Communication Methods

- ✓ There are several communication methods that are used to share information among project stakeholders.
- ✓ These methods are broadly classified as follows:
 - **Interactive communication** – *includes: meetings, phone calls, instant messaging, video conferencing, etc.*
 - **Push communication** – *includes: letters, memos, reports, emails, faxes, voice mails, blogs, press releases, etc.*
 - **Pull communication** – *includes: intranet sites, e-learning, lessons learned databases, knowledge repositories, etc.*



Managing Communications

- Managing communications is a large part of a project manager's job
- Getting project information to the right people at the right time and in a useful format is just as important as developing the information in the first place
- Important considerations include the use of technology, the appropriate methods and media to use, and performance reporting



Using Technology to Enhance Creation and Distribution

- Technology can facilitate the process of creating and distributing information, when used properly
- It is important to select the appropriate communication method and media



Media Choice Table

KEY: 1 = EXCELLENT HOW WELL MEDIUM IS SUITED TO:	2 = ADEQUATE		3 = INAPPROPRIATE			
	HARD COPY	TELEPHONE CALL	VOICE MAIL	E-MAIL	MEETING	WEB SITE
Assessing commitment	3	2	3	3	1	3
Building consensus	3	2	3	3	1	3
Mediating a conflict	3	2	3	3	1	3
Resolving a misunderstanding	3	1	3	3	2	3
Addressing negative behavior	3	2	3	2	1	3
Expressing support/appreciation	1	2	2	1	2	3
Encouraging creative thinking	2	3	3	1	3	3
Making an ironic statement	3	2	2	3	1	3
Conveying a reference document	1	3	3	3	3	1
Reinforcing one's authority	1	2	3	3	1	2
Providing a permanent record	1	3	3	1	3	1
Maintaining confidentiality	2	1	2	3	1	3
Conveying simple information	3	2	1	1	2	3
Asking an informational question	3	2	1	1	3	3
Making a simple request	3	3	1	1	3	3
Giving complex instructions	3	3	3	2	1	2
Addressing many people	2	3	3 or 1*	2	3	1

Galati, Tess. Email Composition and Communication (EmC2) Practical Communications, Inc. (www.praccomm.com) (2001).

*Depends on system functionality

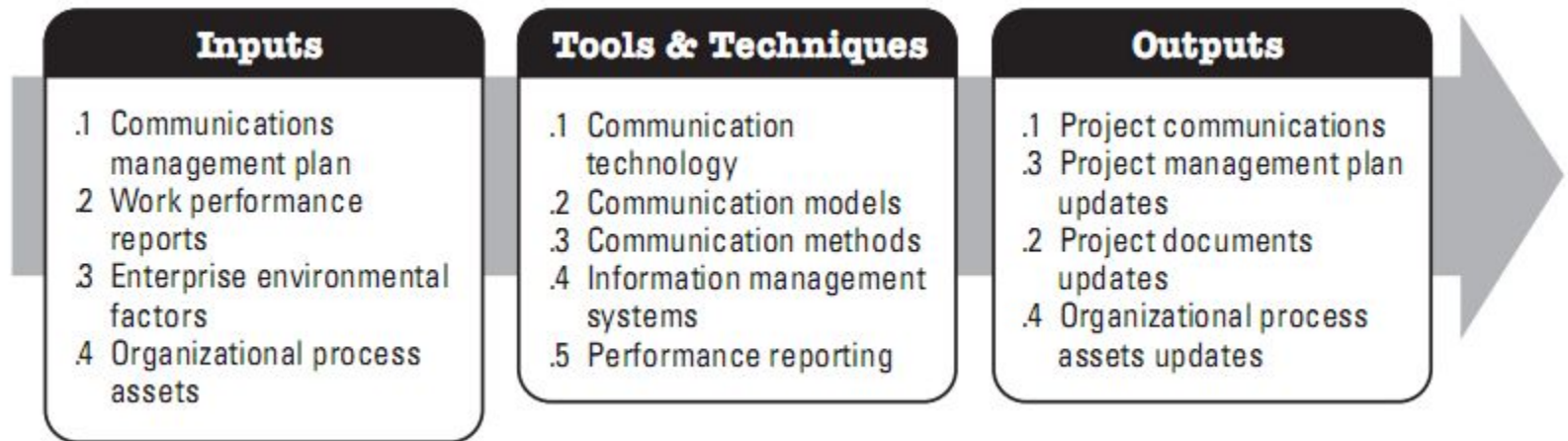


Reporting Performance

Performance reporting keeps stakeholders informed about how resources are being used to achieve project objectives

- **Status reports** describe where the project stands at a specific point in time
- **Progress reports** describe what the project team has accomplished during a certain period of time
- **Forecasts** predict future project status and progress based on past information and trends

Manage Communications ITTO

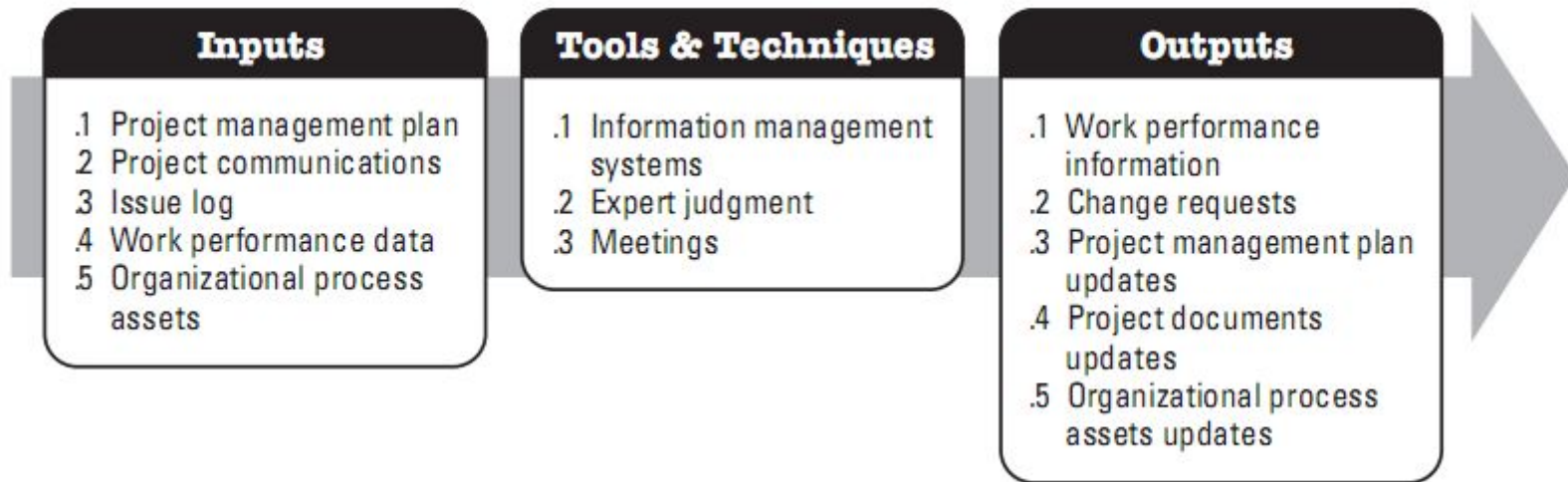




Controlling Communications

- The main goal of controlling communications is to ensure the optimal flow of information throughout the entire project life cycle
- The project manager and project team should use their various reporting systems, expert judgment, and meetings to assess how well communications are working. If problems exist, the project manager and team need to take action, which often requires changes to the earlier processes of planning and managing project communications
- It is often beneficial to have a facilitator from outside the project team assess how well communications are working

Control Communication ITTO





Suggestions for Improving Project Communications

- Develop better communication skills
- Run effective meetings
- Use e-mail and other technologies effectively
- Use templates for project communications



Developing Better Communication Skills

- Most companies spend a lot of money on technical training for their employees, even when employees might benefit more from communications training
- Individual employees are also more likely to enroll voluntarily in classes to learn the latest technology than in classes that develop soft skills
- As organizations become more global, they realize they must invest in ways to improve communication with people from different countries and cultures
- It takes leadership to improve communication





Running Effective Meetings

- Determine if a meeting can be avoided
- Define the purpose and intended outcome of the meeting
- Determine who should attend the meeting
- Provide an agenda to participants before the meeting
- Prepare handouts and visual aids, and make logistical arrangements ahead of time
- Run the meeting professionally
- Set the ground rules for the meeting
- Build relationships



Using E-Mail, Instant Messaging, Texting, and Collaborative Tools Effectively

- Make sure that e-mail, instant messaging, texting, or collaborative tools are an appropriate medium for what you want to communicate
- Be sure to send information to the right people
- Use meaningful subject lines and limit the content of emails to one main subject, and be as clear and concise as possible
- Be sure to authorize the right people to share and edit your collaborative documents



Sample Collaborative Tools

- A **SharePoint portal** allows users to create custom Web sites to access documents and applications stored on shared devices
- **Google Docs** allow users to create, share, and edit documents, spreadsheets, and presentations online
- A **wiki** is a Web site designed to enable anyone who accesses it to contribute or modify Web page content



Best Practice

- Alaska Airlines uses secure project wikis to facilitate project communications and collaborations
- Benefits include:
 - Better documentation
 - Improved trust and information sharing
 - Sustained growth
- The Alaska Airlines IT department even created a “Mother of All Wikis” to serve as an index for all the known project wikis



Using Templates for Project Communications

- Many technical people are afraid to ask for help
- Providing examples and templates for project communications saves time and money
- Organizations can develop their own templates, use some provided by outside organizations, or use samples from textbooks
- Recall that research shows that companies that excel in project management make effective use of templates

Sample Template for a Project Description (corrected from p. 427)

Project X Description

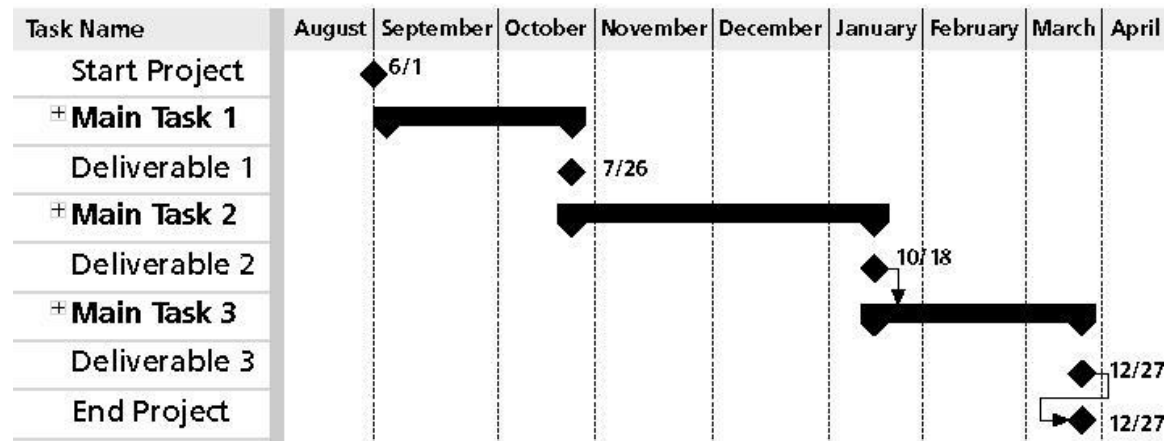
Objective: Describe the objective of the project in one or two sentences. Focus on the business benefits of doing the project.

Scope: Briefly describe the scope of the project. What business functions are involved, and what are the main products the project will produce?

Assumptions: Summarize the most critical assumptions for the project.

Cost: Provide the total estimated cost of the project. If desired, list the total cost each year.

Schedule: Provide summary information from the project's Gantt chart, as shown. Focus on summary tasks and milestones.





Sample Template for a Monthly Progress Report

I. Accomplishments for Month of January (or appropriate month):

- Describe most important accomplishments. Relate to project's Gantt chart.
- Describe other important accomplishments, one bullet for each. If any issues were resolved from the previous month, list them as accomplishments.

II. Plans for February (or following month):

- Describe most important items to be accomplished in the next month. Again, relate to the project's Gantt chart.
- Describe other important items to accomplish, one bullet for each.

III. Issues: Briefly list important issues that surfaced or are still important. Managers hate surprises and want to help the project succeed, so be sure to list issues.

IV. Project Changes (Date and Description): List any approved or requested changes to the project. Include the date of the change and a brief description.





Final Project Documentation Items

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| I. | Project description |
| II. | Project proposal and backup data (request for proposal, statement of work, proposal correspondence, and so on) |
| III. | Original and revised contract information and client acceptance documents |
| IV. | Original and revised project plans and schedules (WBS, Gantt charts and network diagrams, cost estimates, communications management plan, etc.) |
| V. | Design documents |
| VI. | Final project report |
| VII. | Deliverables, as appropriate |
| VIII. | Audit reports |
| IX. | Lessons-learned reports |
| X. | Copies of all status reports, meeting minutes, change notices, and other written and electronic communications |





Lessons Learned Reports

- The project manager and project team members should each prepare a **lessons-learned report**
 - A reflective statement that documents important things an individual learned from working on the project
- The project manager often combines information from all of the lessons-learned reports into a project summary report



Project Archives

- It is also important to organize and prepare project archives
- **Project archives** are a complete set of organized project records that provide an accurate history of the project
- These archives can provide valuable information for future projects as well



Project Web Sites

- Many project teams create a project Web site to store important product documents and other information
- Can create the site using various types of software, such as enterprise project management software

Microsoft's Project Web Application Master Project Summary Screen

Site Actions

Browse

Projects

New

Open

Update List

Build Team

Resource Plan

Project Permissions

Check in My Projects

Close Tasks to Update

Project Site

Zoom In

Zoom Out

Scroll to Project

Outline

View

Filter

Group By

Summary

No Filter

No Group

Export to Excel

Print

Subprojects

Time with Date

Change

Project

Navigate

Zoom

Data

Share

Show/Hide

Project Type

		Project Name	Start	Finish	% Complete	Work	Duration
Projects		EL Bolillo GC - Final 2	1/31/2012	4/2/2012	21%	717.5h	44.5d
Project Center		El Bolillo Wayside	2/7/2012	5/3/2012	99%	13,293h	63d
Approval Center		El Bolillo Website - Final	1/31/2012	4/2/2012	51%	700.4h	44.5d
Workflow Approvals		EL Bolillo Website Team - Final 3	1/31/2012	4/29/2012	59%	219.75h	64d
My Work		elbolilloteam32GT	1/25/2012	5/2/2012	100%	190.4h	71d
		elbolilloteam32GT	2/5/2012	2/5/2012	0%	0h	0d
Tasks		ERP POS	1/20/2012	4/25/2012	100%	486.48h	97d
Timesheet		ESCH Search Engine Optimization	2/2/2012	4/8/2012	99%	52.64h	376d
Issues and Risks		Eternal Gems Inc - db	1/23/2012	4/6/2012	100%	67.1h	54.03d
		EternalGemsInc	1/23/2012	4/8/2012	100%	88.33h	55d
Settings		Fall 4374 Syllabus - DRAFT 1	8/23/2011	12/7/2011	0%	3.5h	76.38d
Personal Settings		Fall 4374 Syllabus - DRAFT 2	8/23/2011	12/7/2011	1%	89.5h	76.38d
Server Settings		Fall 4379 Seats Syllabus - DRAFT 1	8/22/2011	12/7/2011	0%	1.5h	77.38d
Manage Timesheets		FINAL Improve It! Solutions WBS	10/1/2011	11/10/2011	100%	95h	28.88d
		Friendship Center Database Project	8/31/2011	12/2/2011	100%	86.88h	68d
Resources		Gantt Chart Making Green for Discovery Green	2/7/2012	4/25/2012	0%	472.8h	57d
Resource Center		Gateway to Care	2/7/2012	4/8/2012	100%	44.95h	347d
Status Reports		Gateway to Care Wordpress Website	4/11/2012	4/24/2012	78%	49.75h	10d
		HAMR	2/6/2012	4/20/2012	100%	64.17h	55d
Strategy		HAMR_Project	2/8/2012	2/8/2012	0%	0h	0d
Driver Library		HauteBaby	3/30/2012	4/27/2012	99%	34.5h	14d
Driver Prioritization		Healing Air Inc	2/9/2012	4/24/2012	100%	86.7h	76d
Portfolio Analyses		Healthy Vending of Texas	8/30/2011	12/2/2011	100%	123.15h	68d
		Healthy Vending of Texas, LLC	9/13/2011	9/13/2011	0%	0h	0d
Business Intelligence		hitanner	2/20/2012	2/20/2012	0%	0h	1d
		Holiday dinner project past	11/24/2003	11/27/2003	0%	28.97h	3.58d



Using Software to Assist in Project Communications

- There are many software tools to aid in project communications
- Today many people telecommute or work remotely at least part-time. TechCast at George Washington University forecasts that by 2019, 30 percent of U.S. private-sector workers could work from home
- Project management software includes new capabilities to enhance virtual communications
- While technology can aid in the communications process, it is not the most important. Far more important is improving an organization's ability to communicate, which often involves cultural change





Chapter Summary

- The goal of project communications management is to ensure timely and appropriate generation, collection, dissemination, storage, and disposition of project information
- Main process include:
 - Plan communications management
 - Manage communications
 - Control communications



References

1. Kathy Schwalbe, **Managing Information Technology Projects 7th Edition**, *Course Technology, Cengage Learning*, 2014
2. A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge: **PMBOK Guide 5th Edition**, *Project Management Institute*, 2013